

and Scriptaculous libraries, by default. However, it can use alternative libraries like Dojo, Yahoo UI or GWT by using plug-ins. Grails tags like *remoteLink*, *formRemote* and *submitToRemote* for AJAX will use the appropriate Javascript library.

For layouts, Grails also uses Sitemesh (<http://www.opensymphony.com/sitemesh/>) to decorate the views. "SiteMesh is a Web-page layout and decoration framework and Web- application integration framework to aid in creating large sites consisting of many pages, for which a consistent look/feel, navigation and layout scheme is required."

Hence, ensuring a reasonable consistency of look and feel between a Grails application and the traditional J2EE application should not be difficult.

URLs

The structure of the URL is 'controller/action/id'. *Controller* is a class. *Action* is a method in the class. *Id* would normally identify the domain object. As you might expect, the URL mapping is controlled by a script, *UrlMappings.groovy*, and you do not have to use the

default settings. This again can be useful when integrating with existing J2EE applications.

In this article, we have briefly explored the possibilities with Grails. A wide range of tutorials and documentation is available to explore it in depth. *A priori*, Grails would appear to be an excellent option for J2EE shops to add new capabilities to their environment using agile development methodologies.

When users are impatient, competition fierce, and the cost of missed opportunities is high, it is worth taking a look at <http://www.grails.org/Testimonials> and, perhaps, there will be an opportunity for your organisation. 

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